

in its ecosystem – everything plays well with everything else. All your contacts, photos, videos, account settings and preferences are synced across all your devices automatically.

The next obvious step in this ecosystem of devices was including your home, and that's exactly what HomeKit and Home are meant for.

HomeKit

HomeKit is Apple's smart home platform that provides a framework for smart home device manufacturers to communicate with each other and your apple devices. It was first announced by Apple at the 2014 Worldwide Developers Conference. It's name is actually made by combining 'Home' and 'Software Developer Kit'.

So what sets the HomeKit framework apart from the other industry standards and why would manufacturers use it when they already have their own iOS apps?

Well, the reason is that HomeKit provides a standard for devices from different manufacturers to communicate with each other and automate actions making your house and devices all the more smarter. A smarthome isn't really a smart house until all the devices are capable of exchanging information and interacting with each other. Also, one of the most important features of HomeKit is its deep integration with Siri, letting you control all



Phillips has a wide range of HomeKit enabled smart devices including the Hue Hub and bulbs shown above.